07. Listening 2

Environment_7.3

Listen to Audio 2. Match each given word/phrase 1-10 from the interview with a definition A-J.

1. Biodiversity.	A in a way that can become disastrous
2. Settlements.	B the transfer of pollen that allows reproduction
3. Critically.	C hunting illegally
4. Deforestation.	D the plants and flowers of an area
5. Poaching.	E an appendix on the back of an animal
6. Tail.	F the sequences that form a chromosome
7. Apes.	G the destruction of wide areas of trees and forests by people
8. Genes.	H places where people come to live
9. Flora.	I the different animals and plants who live in a specific habitat
10. Pollination.	J large animals with no tail

07. Listening 2

Environment_7.4

Listen to Audio 2. Mark each sentence T (true) or F (false).

1. Borneo and Sumatra are surrounded by water. _____
2. There's a large variety of species in Borneo and Sumatra. _____
3. Sumatran tigers often live close to people. _____
4. The number of Sumatran tigers now is extremely low. _____
5. Pygmy elephant are very short. _____
6. Pigmy elephant are less endangered than Sumatran tigers. _____
7. Orangutans live in groups. _____
8. Orangutans are not very similar to humans. _____
9. In Borneo and Sumatra, only animals are endangered. _____
10. Not many species of animals have disappeared. _____

07. Listening 2 Keys

07.3	1I	2H	3A	4G	5C	6E	7J	8F	9D	10B
07.4	1T	2T	3F	4T	5F	6T	7F	8F	9F	10F

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07. Listening 2 Script

Two Natural Paradises at Risk: Borneo and Sumatra - Audioscript 2

Borneo and Sumatra are two big islands in Southeast Asia. Their wide biodiversity includes some of the world's most endangered species of animals, with wonderful creatures like the Sumatran tiger, the orangutan, the pygmy elephant, and spectacular plants and flowers, as for example one of the largest, and smelliest, flowers in the world: the *Rafflesia*.

Sumatran tigers tend to live in the central areas of forests, and avoid areas with human settlements. The number of these magnificent felines has been declining in the last decades, and the species is currently listed as critically endangered, meaning that there are only about one hundred individuals still surviving. The main causes of this dramatic reduction in their number are deforestation and illegal trade, including hunting and poaching.

The pygmy elephants of Borneo typically have big ears and long tails. The adjective in their name means that they are short, though they are often similar in height to other Asian elephants. Their number is a little higher than that of Sumatran tigers, but it is definitely a species that WWF officially classifies as "endangered".

Orangutans are large apes who often live solitary lives. Their name means "man of the forest" in the Malay language, and this reminds us how close this creature is to us: indeed, scientists say that orangutans share over 96% of our genes and are therefore extremely intelligent beings. The overall number of orangutans has more than halved over the last century, making them a critically endangered species. Again, the main causes of the reduction in their number are habitat destruction and illegal trade.

07. Listening 2 Script

The outstanding biodiversity of these two islands includes some extraordinary flora which, sadly, is also endangered. For example, a flower called *Rafflesia*, which is present in Asia in a variety of species, is at risk of extinction. One of such varieties can be found in Borneo and it is probably the largest known flower in the world. The reduction in their number is due to habitat loss, but also to the fact that successful pollination is quite rare in this species.

These are only a few examples of the many animals and plants who are at critical risk of extinction. Many others have already completely disappeared, and we must do our best to preserve as many species as possible.

The extinction of a species is a loss of biodiversity on Earth, which puts the food chain, water sources and other resources at risk. Without enough biodiversity, ecosystems deteriorate until they no longer exist. And this will kill our planet.